

OnePlus 12

Textbook flagship

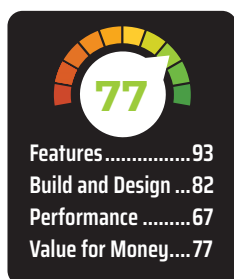
The OnePlus 12 comes as the third Qualcomm Snapdragon 8 Gen 3-powered flagship to land in India. The smartphone competes directly with the iQOO 12, which has been one of the most powerful smartphones that have come to India in this latest generation of flagship Android smartphones. The OnePlus 12 aims to challenge exactly that as this, like the iQOO 12, is also a smartphone preferred mostly by the enthusiasts.

The OnePlus 12, however, seems to be a more premium offering, catering to a larger audience that wants a larger flagship experience, including all your premium features like wireless charging or a proper IP rating. So in this review, that is exactly what I will focus on - how the OnePlus 12 performs and how good the smartphone is in offering us a full-fledged flagship experience.

DESIGN

Starting as usual with the design, the OnePlus 12 carries forward the brand's new design language that we saw with the OnePlus 11 last year. We get a similar rounded camera module with the curved glass on both the front and the back. This year, there are minor differences as compared to last year's OnePlus 11. For example, the camera module also has a frame this time around, which bleeds out of the whole smartphone's frame. Looks kind of cool, like the camera module's frame has been folded out of the bigger frame to fit on the cameras.

We also get a familiar finish on the back panel. This year's back panel has the same texture as last year's OnePlus 11 Marble Odyssey Edition, which gives users a marble-like feel with the glass back panel. The OnePlus 12 also has the



same marble finish on the back panel. As compared to the OnePlus 11, the OnePlus 12 is also a bigger smartphone and the camera module on this is also visibly larger.

Up front, however, things are similar. We get the same curved display with the hole punch camera. On the OnePlus 12, however, the display is slightly wider as compared to the OnePlus 11. So overall, this is clearly a OnePlus design and carries forward OnePlus' new design language with the round camera module. I personally really like the marble-like finish on the back panel, but it looked better with the cream colour on the OnePlus 11, as compared to the green on the OnePlus 12.

DISPLAY

This is the brightest display we have ever seen on a smartphone, at least in terms of the claims that the brand is making. The OnePlus 12 is said to have a peak brightness of 4,500 nits. Now, this is the brightest part of the display in HDR and isn't the case with SDR content. So basically, while using the

phone, you are not seeing things in 4,500 nits. But how much are we seeing actually? Well, in a brightly lit environment like a bright sun outdoors, the smartphone puts out 1876 nits of peak brightness.

Coming to colour accuracy, the OnePlus 12 here also showcases very good results. The smartphone represents colours very accurately, as compared to what we see with naked eyes. Even the greyscale balance on this display is very good. The smartphone also comes equipped with Dolby Vision and HDR10+ so you can stream ultra high resolution content on this smartphone. I watched a few movies and TV shows on the OnePlus 12 and in my opinion, watching content on this curved display is quite an immersive experience.

Further, the 120Hz refresh rate paired with LTPO also makes your daily basic usage smooth and responsive. So yes, overall, this is a brilliant smartphone display. All in terms of sunlight visibility, in terms of colours, and in terms of how responsive it is. I would in fact go as far as saying that this is the best display on any OnePlus smartphone that I have tested so far (I did not test the OnePlus Open).

PERFORMANCE

Coming to performance, the OnePlus 12 is the second smartphone that I am testing with the Qualcomm Snapdragon 8 Gen 3 chipset. And in terms of performance, the OnePlus 12 is right up there with the competition. The smartphone is as speedy as it gets, but still comes right behind the iQOO 12 in terms of pure numbers.

In synthetic benchmarks, the OnePlus 12 was not able to match up to its fiercest rival in the enthusiast-level smartphones, the iQOO 12. Even when compared to the MediaTek Dimensity 9300-powered Vivo X100 Pro, the OnePlus 12 comes behind in terms of the numbers in benchmark scores.

However, that doesn't mean that the experience is not as good. The OnePlus 12, despite the rather slim benchmark numbers, is an absolute beast when